for tracking and using social media. Uploaded on the party's website as part of a national training programme—the Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya Prashikshan Mahabhiyan—the official guidebook gave a clear message to office-bearers on how to use the medium:[14]

Political parties generally start campaigning when elections are near. However, successful political parties are always trying to reach out to people, communicating with them, disseminating correct information and addressing grievances, if any. Social media makes this easier and BJP workers must be in the forefront of this initiative. They are closest to the people/voter and what they do and say will have a large say in defining the image of the party in the minds of potential voters. However, the primary objective of your social media effort is to engage with citizens to disseminate right kind of messages so as to enhance BJP's image and to improve its voter-base. There are many other benefits to using social media. Some of them are:

i. Use of Social Media is mostly free
ii. You have a huge audience which can be reached with less effort and minimal cost.
iii. It's another communication tool to be utilised alongside more traditional methods.
iv. You can engage easily with your target segment.

The publishing of the handbook was a visible marker of how the party internally approached its digital outreach ahead of the 2019 general election. It was also intimately connected with, and aimed at leveraging, the digital revolution that unfolded in India between 2016 and 2019.

This is critical because the 2019 general election was India's first national election that unfolded in a truly digital India—with the second-highest smartphone penetration in the world[15] and the highest average data usage per smartphone, reaching 9.8 gigabytes (GB) per month at the end of 2018.[16] In terms of political impact, this digital transformation has been comparatively understudied. From the invention of the Gutenberg press in medieval Europe, which powered the Reformation and the European Renaissance, to mobile